THE ELONAI DEVOTIONAL COLLECTION

A 21-DAY DEVOTIONAL FOR SINGLES & COUPLES

Kept

21 Days on Love, Waiting & God's Design



"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life"

ELONAI
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Kept: 21 Days on Love, Waiting & God's Design

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A LETTER TO YOU

Dear friend,

Maybe you picked up this book because you're tired of waiting. Maybe you're dating someone and wondering if this is the one. Maybe you're married, and love has turned out to be harder work than the movies promised. Wherever you are, I'm so glad you're here.

Our culture tells us that love is a feeling to follow wherever it leads. Scripture tells a different and far better story: love is a gift from God, a covenant to keep, and the heart is a garden worth guarding.

This book is a free gift, and it isn't a rulebook. It's an invitation to bring your love life, your longings and your questions to the God who designed love in the first place, and who loves you more than any person ever could.

Each day takes about ten minutes. You'll read one passage of Scripture, hold onto one truth, try one small practice, pray and write. The first week is about your own heart, the second about choosing with wisdom, and the third about building a love that lasts.

If you're single, the third week is not off-limits to you. It will help you know what to look for and what to become. If you're married, the first week is not behind you. Every heart needs guarding, every season.

Whatever your story so far, you are not too late and you are not too broken. Let's begin.

With love,
Elonai

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

The One at the Center

Every page of this book points to one Person. Before Day 1, let's make sure you know Him.

The Bible tells us that God made us to know Him and to rest in Him. But all of us have gone our own way. Scripture calls that sin, and it leaves us separated from God — restless, carrying burdens we were never meant to carry alone.

God didn't leave us there. He sent His Son.

> *For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.*
>
> JOHN 3:16 · KJV

Jesus lived the life we couldn't live, died on the cross for our sins, and rose again on the third day. He is alive today, and He still says the same words He spoke two thousand years ago:

> *Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.*
>
> MATTHEW 11:28 · KJV

You can't earn this. You receive it. *"If thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved"* (Romans 10:9).

IF YOU WANT TO FOLLOW JESUS, YOU CAN PRAY SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Jesus, I'm tired of carrying everything on my own. I believe You are the Son of God, that You died for my sins and rose again. I turn from my own way and I trust You. Forgive me, fill me with Your Holy Spirit, and be my Lord. Amen.

If you prayed that for the first time, write today's date here: _____ . Then tell someone — a Christian friend, a local church, or our community (see the end of this book). We would love to celebrate with you.

HOW THIS WORKS

Ten minutes. Twenty-one days.

Each day has two pages. The first page is for **reading**; the second is for **responding**.

i.

Read

A short reading built around one passage of Scripture and one truth about God.

ii.

Hold one truth

A single sentence to carry with you all day. Short enough to remember at 3 a.m.

iii.

Practice & pray

One small, concrete step for today, and a written prayer you can pray as your own.

iv.

Write it down

An honest question and space to answer. Writing slows racing thoughts and helps you notice God's answers.

The journey

Week One — Guard Your Heart. Your worth, your longings and your waiting, held in God's hands.
Week Two — Choose With Wisdom. What Scripture says to look for, and what to walk away from.
Week Three — Build to Last. The everyday habits of a love that keeps its promises.

A TIP THAT MAKES ALL THE DIFFERENCE

People who decide *exactly when and where* they'll do something are far more likely to follow through. On the next page, choose your time and place — and tie it to something you already do every day, like your morning coffee.

Reading on a phone or tablet? Write your answers in a notebook, or open this PDF in an app like GoodNotes and write right on the page.

MY COMMITMENT

I'm showing up for 21 days.

Every day, after I _____ ,

I will open *Kept* at _____ in _____ .

I'm starting on _____ . My one-word prayer: _____

✦

Color in a circle each day you finish. Watch the chain grow.

WEEK ONE · GUARD YOUR HEART

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

WEEK TWO · CHOOSE WITH WISDOM

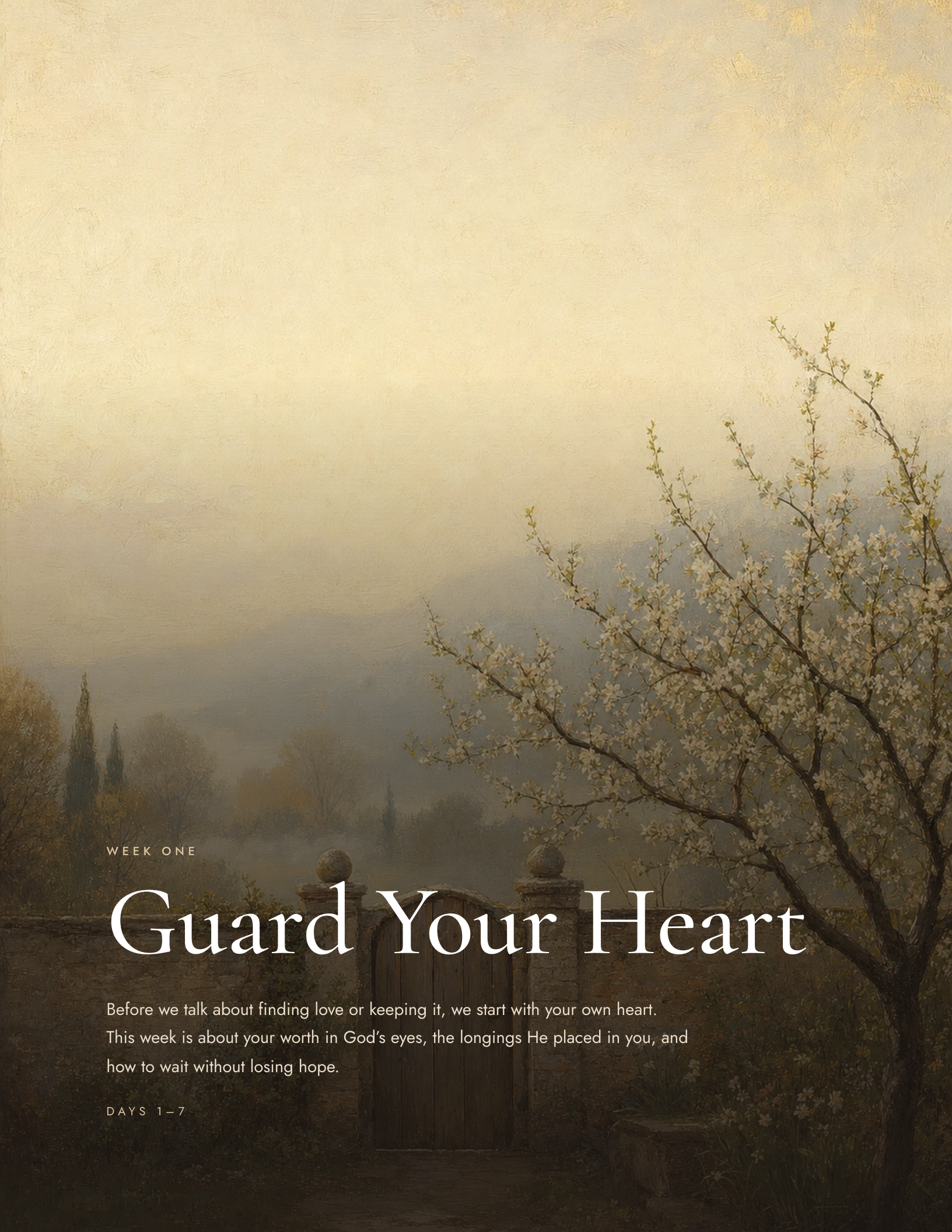
8 9 10 11 12 13 14

WEEK THREE · BUILD TO LAST

15 16 17 18 19 20 21

MISSED A DAY?

Don't start over and don't feel guilty. Missing a day here and there doesn't undo your progress. Just turn to the next day and keep going. *His mercies are new every morning.*



WEEK ONE

Guard Your Heart

Before we talk about finding love or keeping it, we start with your own heart. This week is about your worth in God's eyes, the longings He placed in you, and how to wait without losing hope.

DAYS 1–7

WEEK ONE Day 01 / 21

A Heart Worth Guarding

We lock our doors, protect our passwords and put cases on our phones. But the most valuable thing we own is often left wide open.

> *Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.*
>
> PROVERBS 4:23 · KJV

Proverbs 4 is a father's advice to his son, and at its center is this sentence: "Keep thy heart with all diligence." The word *keep* pictures a guard posted at a gate. *Diligence* means doing it carefully and constantly. This isn't a one-time decision; it's a daily watch.

Why such care? "For out of it are the issues of life." In the Bible, the heart is more than emotions. It's the center of who you are: your desires, thoughts, choices and loves. Whatever gets into your heart will eventually flow out into your words, your relationships and your future.

Guarding your heart doesn't mean building a wall so no one can ever get close. A walled garden still has a gate. It means deciding who and what gets in, and when. It means not handing your heart to someone who hasn't shown they can care for it, and not feeding it on fantasies that leave you restless.

The best guard for your heart is the One who made it. Paul promised that "the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus" (Philippians 4:7). You don't have to stand watch alone. Today, invite God to stand at the gate with you.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 1

My heart is valuable. God will help me guard it.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Notice what you feed your heart today: shows, songs, scrolling, conversations. Write down one thing that leaves you restless, and take a break from it for these 21 days.

PRAY

Father, You made my heart and You know it better than I do. I've left the gate open in places I shouldn't have. Stand guard with me. Teach me what to let in and what to keep out, and fill my heart with Your peace. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What has been shaping my heart the most lately when it comes to love and relationships? Is it helping me or hurting me?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Before there was sin, before there was pain, God looked at His perfect world and said one thing was "not good." Tomorrow we find out what it was.

WEEK ONE Day 02 / 21

Not Good to Be Alone

Have you ever felt a little guilty for wanting someone to share your life with, as if loving God should be enough to make that longing disappear?

> *And the LORD God said, It is not good that the man should be alone; I will make him an help meet for him.*
>
> GENESIS 2:18 · KJV

Six times in Genesis 1, God looks at His creation and calls it good. Then, in a perfect garden, with no sin anywhere, God says something surprising: "It is not good that the man should be alone." The first thing in the Bible called "not good" was loneliness.

That means your desire for companionship is not a weakness or a lack of faith. God Himself put it there. We were made in the image of a God who has always existed in relationship as Father, Son and Holy Spirit. We were made for connection.

The phrase "help meet" means a helper suitable for him, one who corresponds to him. The Hebrew word for helper, *ezer*, is used elsewhere in the Bible for God Himself: "he is our help and our shield" (Psalm 33:20). It is not a lesser role. It's a word of strength.

Not everyone will marry, and marriage is not the only answer to loneliness. God also gives friendship, family and the church. But today, hear this: the longing in you is not wrong. Bring it to God honestly. He's the One who first said you weren't meant to do life alone.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 2

My longing for love is not a flaw. God made me for connection.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Tell God plainly, out loud or on paper, what you long for in love. Then reach out to one friend today, just to connect.

PRAY

Lord, You know the longing in my heart. Thank You that it isn't something to hide from You. I bring it to You honestly. Meet me in my loneliness, surround me with good people, and help me trust Your plan for my life. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What do I truly long for in love? Write it honestly, as a prayer.

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow If our longing is from God, what do we do while we wait for it to be met? Tomorrow we read one of the most freeing verses about who you already are.

WEEK ONE Day 03 / 21

Complete in Him

Movies love the line "You complete me." It's romantic. It's also a heavy weight to put on any human being.

> *For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily. And ye are complete in him, which is the head of all principality and power:*
>
> COLOSSIANS 2:9–10 · KJV

The believers in Colossae were being told they needed something extra to be truly spiritual: special rules, secret knowledge, the right experiences. Paul answered by pointing to Jesus. In Him lives "all the fulness of the Godhead bodily." Nothing is missing in Christ.

Then Paul turns to us: "And ye are complete in him." If you belong to Jesus, you are not half a person waiting for your other half. You are already whole, already chosen, already loved. Your worth was settled at the cross, not at the altar.

This matters because when we look for another person to complete us, we tend to cling, to settle or to crush them with expectations no human can carry. But when we know we're complete in Christ, we can love freely. We give from fullness instead of grasping from emptiness.

Marriage is a good gift, but it was never meant to be your savior. Only Jesus can carry that weight. Whether you're single, dating or married today, let this truth sink in: you are not waiting to become whole. In Him, you already are.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 3

I am not half a person. In Christ, I am already complete.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write "Complete in Him" on a sticky note and put it where you get ready each morning. Read it out loud every day this week.

PRAY

Jesus, I've looked for people to complete me, and I've been disappointed. Thank You that in You I lack nothing. Let my sense of worth rest on Your love, not on whether someone chooses me. Help me love others from fullness, not from fear. Amen.

JOURNAL

Where have I expected a person (or the hope of one) to give me what only God can give?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow There's a promise about "the desires of thine heart" that is often misunderstood. Tomorrow we read the first half of the verse, the part most people skip.

WEEK ONE Day 04 / 21

Delight First

This verse has been written on a thousand wedding cards and dating-app bios. But it isn't a vending machine, and it's better than one.

> *Delight thyself also in the LORD; and he shall give thee the desires of thine heart. Commit thy way unto the LORD; trust also in him; and he shall bring it to pass.*
>
> PSALM 37:4–5 · KJV

Psalm 37 was written by David, an older man looking back on life. Again and again he says, "Fret not." Don't envy those who seem to get everything easily. Instead, trust, delight, commit and rest. Verse 4 sits in the middle of that calm advice.

"Delight thyself also in the LORD." To delight is to find your joy and pleasure in someone. David doesn't say, "Delight in the Lord so you can get what you want." He says, make God Himself your joy. Then something beautiful happens: "he shall give thee the desires of thine heart."

When God becomes our delight, He does two things with our desires. He fulfills the good ones in His time and way, and He gently reshapes the others until they match His heart. Many people who delighted in God found that what they wanted most changed.

Verse 5 adds the posture of trust: "Commit thy way unto the LORD." The word *commit* pictures rolling a heavy load onto someone else. Roll your love story onto Him. He is not careless with it, and "he shall bring it to pass."

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 4

When God is my delight, He takes care of my desires.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Do one thing today simply because you enjoy God: a walk while thanking Him, a worship song, reading a psalm slowly. Ask for nothing. Just enjoy Him.

PRAY

Lord, I confess I've often delighted in the idea of love more than in You. Be my first joy. I roll my love story onto You. Fulfill the desires that are from You, and change the ones that aren't. I trust You with the timing. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What are the desires of my heart right now? Which ones feel like they're from God, and which might He want to reshape?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow The most romantic book of the Bible repeats one warning three times. Tomorrow we look at it, and why it's actually a kindness.

WEEK ONE Day 05 / 21

Not Before Its Time

You can force a flower open with your fingers. But it won't bloom. It will only tear.

> *I charge you, O ye daughters of Jerusalem, by the roes, and by the hinds of the field, that ye stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please.*
>
> SONG OF SOLOMON 2:7 · KJV

The Song of Solomon is a love poem, full of longing and delight between a bride and her groom. God thought romantic love was worth celebrating in His Word. But right in the middle of the poetry, the bride turns to her friends with a warning, and she repeats it three times in the book (2:7, 3:5, 8:4).

"Stir not up, nor awake my love, till he please." Many translations render it "do not awaken love until it pleases." In other words: don't rush it. Don't awaken the full force of romantic and physical love before its time. Love is powerful, and like fire, it is beautiful in the fireplace and destructive in the living room.

This is not a warning against feelings. It's wisdom about timing. When we rush into emotional or physical intimacy before commitment, we often bond to people who were never meant to hold our hearts, and we carry those wounds into the future.

Waiting is not denying love; it's protecting it. If you've already rushed ahead, there is grace for you. God doesn't throw away what has been torn. He restores. Today, ask Him for patience to let love unfold in His time.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 5

Love is worth waiting for. God's timing protects what I treasure.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

If you're dating, talk honestly together about your boundaries this week. If you're single, write down the pace you want a future relationship to move at.

PRAY

Father, I want to rush ahead so often. Thank You that Your timing is not to punish me but to protect me. Give me patience to let love bloom in its season. Where I've already rushed, heal and restore my heart. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Where am I tempted to rush love: emotionally, physically or in my imagination? What would it look like to wait well?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Waiting can feel like wasted time, as if real life starts later. Tomorrow we meet a promise for tired waiters, complete with wings.

WEEK ONE Day 06 / 21

Waiting Is Not Wasting

Weddings you attended alone. Birthdays that came faster than answers. Waiting can wear a heart down.

> *But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.*
>
> ISAIAH 40:31 · KJV

Isaiah wrote to God's people in a long, hard season, when it seemed like God had forgotten them. They said, "My way is hid from the LORD" (40:27). Have you ever felt that? As if God has your file somewhere at the bottom of the pile?

Isaiah's answer is that the everlasting God "fainteth not, neither is weary" (40:28). He hasn't lost track of you. And then comes the promise: "they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength." To wait upon the Lord isn't to sit in a waiting room staring at the door. It's to lean on Him, expect Him and stay close to Him.

Notice the order: mount up, run, walk. Sometimes God gives you soaring days. Sometimes He gives you strength to run. And on many ordinary days, He gives you grace simply to keep walking without fainting. That counts too.

Your life is not on hold. This season is not a hallway; it's a room where God is doing real work in you. Serve, grow, build friendships, follow your calling. The person God is shaping you into matters far more than the date on which your story changes.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 6

My life is not on hold. God is working in me right now.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Make a list of three things you can invest in during this season: a skill, a ministry, a friendship. Take one step toward one of them this week.

PRAY

Lord, I'm tired of waiting sometimes. Thank You that You never grow weary and You haven't forgotten me. Renew my strength today. Help me live fully in this season instead of wishing it away. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What has God been doing in me during this season of waiting that I might not have noticed?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Paul saw something in singleness that most of us miss. We close Week One by looking at a season with its own unique gifts.

WEEK ONE Day 07 / 21

Single and Whole

Some people treat singleness like a waiting room. Paul treated it like an open door.

> *But I would have you without carefulness. He that is unmarried careth for the things that belong to the Lord, how he may please the Lord:*
>
> 1 CORINTHIANS 7:32 · KJV

The church in Corinth had questions about marriage, and Paul answered them honestly. He called both marriage and singleness gifts from God (7:7). Then he pointed out something about the single season: it carries a unique freedom to focus on the Lord.

"He that is unmarried careth for the things that belong to the Lord." Paul isn't saying married people can't serve God. He's saying that singleness, whether for a season or for life, gives flexibility, time and attention that can be poured into God's kingdom in ways that are harder later.

Some of the most fruitful people in history did their greatest work while single. Jesus Himself, fully human and fully whole, never married. Singleness is not second-class Christianity, and a single person is not an unfinished person.

If you're single today, ask God how He wants to use this season, not just how to get out of it. If you're married, look around your church for single friends and include them. Every member of the body matters, at every stage of life. That's how Week One ends: whole, loved and useful in His hands.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 7

My season of life is not second-best. God has a purpose for it.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Single: ask God for one way to serve Him this month that this season makes possible. Married: invite a single friend to a meal this week.

PRAY

Father, thank You that I'm not unfinished in Your eyes. Whatever season I'm in, I offer it to You. Use my time, my energy and my freedom for Your kingdom. Help me see my life as full, not empty. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What unique freedom or opportunity does my current season of life give me? How could I use it for God?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Week Two begins with a farming picture: two animals, one yoke. Tomorrow we find out why it matters who you pull alongside.

WELL DONE

You finished Week One.

Seven days of showing up. That matters more than you know. Before you move on, take a moment to look back.

THE TRUTH I NEEDED MOST THIS WEEK

WHERE I SAW GOD AT WORK

YOU DON'T HAVE TO DO THIS ALONE

Join our free community walking through *Kept* together. Share what God is doing, post a prayer request, and pray for one another. Scan the code, or on your phone tap here to join.

Coming up in Week Two: **Choose With Wisdom**



WEEK TWO

Choose With Wisdom

Love is more than chemistry. This week we look at what Scripture says to look for in a partner, the people who should speak into your choices, and why purity is a path to freedom.

DAYS 8–14

WEEK TWO Day 08 / 21

Pulling in the Same Direction

Picture two oxen joined by one wooden yoke. One wants to go left, the other wants to go right. Neither gets very far.

> *Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness?*
>
> 2 CORINTHIANS 6:14 · KJV

A yoke was a heavy wooden beam that joined two animals so they could plow together. Farmers knew that if you yoked a strong ox with a weak donkey, or two animals that pulled in different directions, the field would be ruined and both animals would be hurt. Paul uses that picture for our closest partnerships.

"Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers." Paul isn't telling us to avoid people who don't share our faith; Jesus ate with sinners and loved them. He's talking about binding your life to someone in a way that pulls you in two directions. Marriage is the closest yoke there is.

When your faith is the center of your life, and it isn't the center of theirs, you're headed for different fields. Your values about money, children, priorities and church will keep pulling apart. Love doesn't erase that; it often makes the ache deeper.

This is one of the hardest truths for people who are lonely or already attached. But God's "no" here is a loving "no." He wants you to share the deepest part of your life, your relationship with Him, with the person you share everything else with.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 8

I want to share my life with someone who shares my love for God.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write down your non-negotiables for a future spouse, or the shared values you want to strengthen in your marriage. Put faith at the top of the list.

PRAY

Lord, I want to walk in the same direction as the one I love. Give me courage to follow Your wisdom even when my feelings pull another way. Guard me from settling, and lead me to someone who loves You more than they love me. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What does it look like to be "equally yoked" beyond simply both calling ourselves Christians?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow When God sent a prophet to choose a king, even the prophet got it wrong at first. Tomorrow we learn what God looks at that we usually miss.

WEEK TWO Day 09 / 21

Look at the Heart

Profile pictures, first impressions, height and smile. We decide so much in the first three seconds.

> *But the LORD said unto Samuel, Look not on his countenance, or on the height of his stature; because I have refused him: for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart.*
>
> 1 SAMUEL 16:7 · KJV

God sent the prophet Samuel to Bethlehem to anoint the next king of Israel from among Jesse's sons. When the oldest, Eliab, walked in, tall and impressive, Samuel thought, "Surely this is the one." God said no. "Man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart."

Seven sons passed by, and none was chosen. The one God wanted was out in the fields with the sheep, not even invited to the meeting. David was young and overlooked, but his heart belonged to God.

Attraction is real and good; the Song of Solomon is full of it. But attraction is the doorway, not the house. Looks fade, charm can be practiced, and confidence can hide a selfish heart. Character is what you'll live with every day.

So how do we look at the heart? Watch how someone treats people who can do nothing for them. Notice how they handle anger, money and disappointment. Listen to how they talk about God when no one's trying to impress anyone. Ask God for His eyes, for others and for yourself.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 9

I want to see people the way God sees them: heart first.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Think of someone you're interested in, dating or married to. List three qualities of their heart you've actually seen in action.

PRAY

Lord, I confess I'm easily impressed by outward things. Give me Your eyes. Help me notice character, kindness and faithfulness. And make my own heart beautiful in Your sight, no matter how I look on the outside. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What outward things have I let matter too much? What heart qualities do I most want in a partner, and in myself?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Proverbs ends with a portrait of a person worth more than rubies, and one line that turns our culture's priorities upside down.

WEEK TWO Day 10 / 21

Character Over Charm

Charm can get you a first date. Character is what makes the fiftieth anniversary.

> *Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised.*
>
> PROVERBS 31:30 · KJV

Proverbs 31 was a mother's advice to her son, the king, about what to look for in a wife. She describes a woman who is strong, wise, generous, hardworking and kind, whose husband trusts her completely. And then she sums it all up in one line: "Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain."

Favour here means charm or attractiveness. *Deceitful* means it can mislead you. *Vain* means fleeting, like a breath. Charm isn't evil, and beauty isn't wrong. They're simply not strong enough to build a life on.

What lasts? "A woman that feareth the LORD." To fear the Lord is to hold Him in such awe and love that you want to honor Him in everything. The same principle is true for men: a man who fears the Lord will be faithful when no one is watching.

This verse is also an invitation to you. Before asking whether someone else has this kind of character, ask God to build it in you. Become the kind of person you're hoping to find. That is never wasted, married or single.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 10

Character lasts longer than charm. I will look for it and grow in it.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Read all of Proverbs 31:10–31 today. Underline one quality you want to grow in, whether you're a man or a woman.

PRAY

Lord, I want my life to be built on what lasts. Help me value character over charm, in others and in myself. Teach me to fear You and to honor You in hidden places. Make me trustworthy. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Which quality of a person who fears the Lord do I most want to grow in? What would one step look like this week?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow One of the most beautiful love stories in the Bible started in a barley field, with a man who noticed a woman's kindness before anything else.

WEEK TWO Day 11 / 21

Known for Kindness

She was a widow and a foreigner, gathering leftover grain to survive. He was a respected landowner. Their story began with a reputation.

> *And now, my daughter, fear not; I will do to thee all that thou requirest: for all the city of my people doth know that thou art a virtuous woman.*
>
> RUTH 3:11 · KJV

Ruth was a young widow from Moab who refused to leave her grieving mother-in-law, Naomi. She moved to a foreign land and worked in the fields to feed them both. Boaz, the owner of the field, noticed her and told her, "It hath fully been shewed me, all that thou hast done unto thy mother in law" (2:11).

Boaz wasn't drawn first by her looks. He was drawn by her loyalty and kindness. And Ruth saw in Boaz a man of integrity: generous to workers, protective of the vulnerable, careful to do things the right way, even when it would have been easier to cut corners (3:12–13).

"All the city of my people doth know that thou art a virtuous woman." The word *virtuous* means strong, capable, of noble character. Ruth didn't build that reputation to catch a husband. She built it by being faithful in ordinary, hard days.

Their love story became part of God's bigger story: their great-grandson was King David, and from his line came Jesus (Matthew 1:5). You never know what God is writing through your quiet faithfulness. Be known for kindness. Let God take care of the rest.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 11

Quiet faithfulness is never wasted. God sees it and writes with it.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Do one act of hidden kindness today for someone who can't repay you, and tell no one.

PRAY

Father, thank You for Ruth and Boaz, and for the way You honor quiet faithfulness. Make me known for kindness, loyalty and integrity. Let my reputation point to You. And write my story into Your bigger story. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What would I want to be known for by the people who see my everyday life? What does my life currently say?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Long before dating apps, one servant had to find a wife for his master's son. Tomorrow we read his first move, and it wasn't what you'd expect.

WEEK TWO Day 12 / 21

Ask Him First

Before he looked at a single face, before he said a single word, the servant stopped by a well and prayed.

> *And he said O LORD God of my master Abraham, I pray thee, send me good speed this day, and shew kindness unto my master Abraham.*
>
> GENESIS 24:12 · KJV

Abraham was old, and he wanted a wife for his son Isaac from among his own people, someone who would share the faith of the family. He sent his most trusted servant on a long journey with ten camels and a big question: how would he know who was the right one?

The servant's first move was prayer. He asked God for success and then asked for a specific sign: a young woman who would not only give him a drink, but offer to water all ten camels, a demanding act of generosity (24:14). Before he had finished praying, Rebekah came out with her water jar (24:15).

Notice what the servant asked to see: not beauty or wealth, but a generous, hardworking heart. And when God answered, the servant didn't celebrate himself. He "bowed down his head, and worshipped the LORD" (24:26).

You don't need a sign at a well to make wise choices, but you do need to start where the servant started: asking God first. Pray before you date, pray while you date, pray before every big decision. He's more interested in your love story than you are.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 12

Before I choose, I will ask. God cares about my love story.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write a specific prayer about your relationship situation, including the qualities you're asking God to help you recognize. Pray it every day this week.

PRAY

Lord God, I don't want to make the biggest decisions of my life without You. Lead me as You led Abraham's servant. Help me recognize good character, and give me wisdom to know when to wait and when to move. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What decision about love or relationships do I need to bring to God right now? What am I asking Him for?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Your closest friends are shaping your love life more than you think. Tomorrow we read a proverb about the company we keep.

WEEK TWO Day 13 / 21

Wise Company

When you're falling for someone, you rarely ask for advice. When it's falling apart, everyone suddenly has an opinion.

> *He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.*
>
> PROVERBS 13:20 · KJV

Proverbs is honest: we become like the people we walk with. Spend your days with wise people and wisdom rubs off on you. Spend them with fools, people who mock God's ways and live only for the moment, and you'll get hurt.

This applies to the person you date, but also to the voices around your relationship. If all your advice comes from movies, social media or friends who've never stayed in a hard relationship, you'll be guided by people who don't know the way.

Love can blind us. That's why God gives us community. Mature believers, parents, mentors and married couples who have walked faithfully for decades can often see what we can't. A wise friend who says "I'm not sure about this" might be God's kindness to you.

Invite wise people into your love life. Introduce the person you're dating to them early. Ask questions and actually listen. And if you're married, find a couple further down the road who can encourage you. Walking with the wise is one of the simplest ways to become wise.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 13

I don't have to figure out love alone. God gives me wise people.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Name two wise people you trust. This week, ask one of them: "What have you learned about love that you wish you'd known sooner?"

PRAY

Father, thank You for the wise people You've put in my life. Give me humility to ask for advice and to listen, especially when it's not what I want to hear. Lead me to mentors and friends who will point me back to You. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Whose voice has the most influence on my view of love right now? Are they leading me toward wisdom?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow We end Week Two with a word many people find uncomfortable. Tomorrow we discover why God's way of purity is actually a path to freedom.

WEEK TWO Day 14 / 21

Purity Is Freedom

People often ask, "What is God's will for my life?" In this passage, Paul answers part of that question very clearly.

> *For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication: That every one of you should know how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honour;*
>
> 1 THESSALONIANS 4:3–4 · KJV

The believers in Thessalonica lived in a culture where almost anything was acceptable sexually. Paul wrote to them plainly: "this is the will of God, even your sanctification." Sanctification means being set apart for God, made holy over time.

Paul names the practical part: "abstain from fornication," which is sex outside of marriage, and learn to "possess his vessel," your body, "in sanctification and honour." God isn't against sex. He created it, and He celebrates it within the covenant of marriage. He is for you, which is why He gives it a safe home.

Purity is not about being afraid of your body or ashamed of your desires. It's about honoring yourself, honoring the person you love, and honoring God. Boundaries in dating are not walls that keep love out; they're riverbanks that keep love flowing in the right direction.

If you've already crossed lines you regret, hear this clearly: you are not damaged goods. "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness" (1 John 1:9). Purity starts fresh today, from a place of grace, not shame.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 14

Purity is not a cage. It's God's way of protecting my heart and my future.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Decide on one practical boundary that will help you honor God in this area (time, place, screens). If you need to, confess something to God and receive His cleansing.

PRAY

Holy God, thank You for creating love and desire, and for giving them a safe home. Forgive me where I've gone my own way. Wash me clean. Give me strength and wisdom to honor You with my body and to honor others too. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What boundaries would help me live in freedom instead of regret? Is there anything I need to bring to God for cleansing?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Week Three begins with the most famous passage about love ever written, and the very first word it uses to describe love isn't romantic at all.

WELL DONE

You finished Week Two.

Seven days of showing up. That matters more than you know. Before you move on, take a moment to look back.

THE TRUTH I NEEDED MOST THIS WEEK

WHERE I SAW GOD AT WORK

YOU DON'T HAVE TO DO THIS ALONE

Join our free community walking through *Kept* together. Share what God is doing, post a prayer request, and pray for one another. Scan the code, or on your phone tap here to join.

Coming up in Week Three: **Build to Last**



WEEK THREE

Build to Last

Lasting love is built one ordinary day at a time. This week is about patience, forgiveness, service and the foundation that holds when the storms come.

DAYS 15–21

WEEK THREE Day 15 / 21

Love Is Patient

It's read at almost every wedding. But Paul didn't write it for a wedding. He wrote it for a church full of people who couldn't get along.

> *Charity suffereth long, and is kind; charity envieth not; charity vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up, Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil;*
>
> 1 CORINTHIANS 13:4–5 · KJV

In the King James Version, *charity* is the word for the Greek *agape*: self-giving love that chooses the good of the other person. Paul was writing to believers in Corinth who were proud, divided and competitive. Their problem wasn't a lack of gifts. It was a lack of love.

Notice the first description: love "suffereth long." Patience. Not passion, not excitement, but the ability to put up with someone's weaknesses for a long time without giving up. Then: kind, not envious, not boastful, not rude, not selfish, not easily angered, not keeping score.

Read the list again and you'll notice that almost all of it is about how we act, not how we feel. Feelings come and go. Love, in the Bible, is a choice we make over and over, especially when the other person is hard to love.

Try this: read verses 4–7 and put your own name in place of "charity." It's humbling. None of us loves like this naturally. But there is One who does: Jesus fits every line perfectly. As we stay close to Him, His love begins to grow in us.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 15

Love is something I do, not only something I feel.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Choose one line from 1 Corinthians 13:4–7 to practice today with someone close to you. Write it on your hand or your phone's lock screen.

PRAY

Jesus, You are patient and kind with me every day. I can't love like this in my own strength. Fill me with Your love. Where I've been impatient, rude or keeping score, forgive me. Teach me to choose love today. Amen.

JOURNAL

When I put my name in 1 Corinthians 13:4–7, which line is hardest for me? Why?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Two people can make a strong team. Tomorrow we discover why the Bible says three is even stronger.

WEEK THREE Day 16 / 21

A Cord of Three

Pull on a single thread and it snaps easily. Braid three together and you can lift something heavy.

> *Two are better than one; because they have a good reward for their labour. For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow … and a threefold cord is not quickly broken.*
>
> ECCLESIASTES 4:9–10, 12 · KJV

The writer of Ecclesiastes spent a lot of time looking at how empty life can feel. But in chapter 4, he notices something good: "Two are better than one." Two people can work together, pick each other up when they fall, keep each other warm and stand together against an attack.

Then he adds a surprising image: "a threefold cord is not quickly broken." Many Christians have seen in this a picture of marriage with God at the center: a husband, a wife and the Lord, braided together. When the two strands are tired or frayed, the third holds.

A relationship built on two people alone depends entirely on their strength, their feelings and their patience. But when both are woven into God, they draw on a strength that isn't theirs. Praying together, reading Scripture together and worshiping together are not extras; they're the braiding.

If you're married, start small: pray together for one minute before bed. If you're dating, practice praying together now. If you're single, build friendships that include God. Every strong cord starts with a few simple twists.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 16

When God is woven into a relationship, it holds stronger.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Pray together with your spouse, the person you're dating, or a close friend today, even if it's just for one minute.

PRAY

Lord, I want You at the center of my relationships, not on the edges. Weave Yourself into my love story. Where we're frayed and tired, hold us together. Teach us to pray together and lean on You. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

How is God woven into my closest relationship right now? What's one way to braid Him in more?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Tomorrow's verse contains one of the most practical pieces of relationship advice ever given, and it has a deadline: sunset.

WEEK THREE Day 17 / 21

Before the Sun Goes Down

Every couple fights. The question isn't whether you'll have conflict. It's what you'll do with it.

> *Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath: Neither give place to the devil.*
>
> EPHESIANS 4:26–27 · KJV

Paul doesn't say, "Never be angry." He says, "Be ye angry, and sin not." Anger is a human emotion, and sometimes it's even right. Jesus Himself was angry at injustice. The problem is not the feeling but what we do next.

"Let not the sun go down upon your wrath." Don't let anger sit overnight and harden into resentment. Unresolved anger is like milk left out on the counter: the longer it sits, the more it spoils. That doesn't mean every issue must be fully solved before bed, but it does mean turning toward each other instead of away.

Paul adds a warning: "Neither give place to the devil." The word *place* means a foothold. Bitterness gives the enemy a place to stand in your relationship. Silence, sarcasm and storing up offenses are like leaving the door unlocked.

Healthy couples learn to fight fair: no name-calling, no bringing up the past as a weapon, no threats. They listen to understand, say "I'm sorry" quickly, and remember they are on the same team. And if a relationship involves abuse or fear, that is not ordinary conflict. Please reach out for help.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 17

I won't let anger harden. I'll turn toward, not away.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Is there an unresolved conflict in your life? Take one step toward peace today: a kind text, an apology, or a request to talk.

PRAY

Lord, You know how quickly I get defensive and how long I can hold on to anger. Help me be angry without sinning. Give me courage to make peace before resentment takes root. Close every door I've opened to bitterness. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

How do I usually handle conflict: explode, withdraw, or work it through? What would a healthier pattern look like?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Every relationship involves two imperfect people. Tomorrow we look at the one habit no love can survive without.

WEEK THREE Day 18 / 21

Forgive as You Were Forgiven

The longer you love someone, the more opportunities they'll have to hurt you. And you them.

> *Forbearing one another, and forgiving one another, if any man have a quarrel against any: even as Christ forgave you, so also do ye. And above all these things put on charity, which is the bond of perfectness.*
>
> COLOSSIANS 3:13–14 · KJV

Paul describes the new life in Christ like changing clothes. Take off anger and bitterness; put on compassion, kindness, humility, meekness and patience. Then he names two things every relationship needs: "Forbearing one another, and forgiving one another."

Forbearing means putting up with each other's quirks and weaknesses: the dishes left in the sink, the habit that drives you crazy. *Forgiving* goes deeper. It means releasing someone from the debt they owe you for a real wrong, choosing not to make them pay.

How can we do that? "Even as Christ forgave you." We forgive from the overflow of having been forgiven much. When we remember how much grace we've received, it becomes harder to hold someone else's sin over their head.

Forgiveness is not pretending the hurt didn't happen, and it doesn't mean staying in a situation where you're unsafe. Trust can take time to rebuild. But forgiveness frees your heart from the prison of bitterness, and above it all, Paul says, "put on charity, which is the bond of perfectness." Love is what holds everything together.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 18

I forgive because I have been forgiven so much.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Think of one person you need to forgive. Pray: "Lord, I release them to You." You may need to pray it many times; that's normal.

PRAY

Jesus, You forgave me completely. I don't deserve it, and I'm so grateful. Help me forgive the way You forgave me. Heal the hurts that make it hard. Clothe me with patience and love, and let Your love hold my relationships together. Amen.

JOURNAL

Who do I need to forgive, and what am I holding against them? What would releasing it look like?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Real love asks a different question than "What am I getting?" Tomorrow we look at the question that changes everything.

WEEK THREE Day 19 / 21

Love That Serves

Many relationships quietly ask, "Are my needs being met?" Jesus asked, "How can I serve?"

> *Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves. Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others.*
>
> PHILIPPIANS 2:3–4 · KJV

Paul urges the believers in Philippi to put away selfish ambition and pride, and to value others above themselves. "Look not every man on his own things, but every man also on the things of others." Then he points to the ultimate example: Jesus, who "made himself of no reputation, and took upon him the form of a servant" (2:7).

This is the heart of a lasting marriage. Paul later tells husbands, "love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it" (Ephesians 5:25), and calls all believers to submit "yourselves one to another in the fear of God" (Ephesians 5:21). Christian love is a race to serve, not a contest to win.

Selfishness kills love slowly: keeping score, demanding your way, expecting to be served. Humility brings love back to life: noticing what the other person needs, doing the unseen task, listening when you'd rather talk.

You don't have to be married to practice this. Roommates, family members and friends all give us daily chances to put others first. The habits you build now are the habits you'll bring into any future marriage.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 19

Love asks, “How can I serve?” before “What am I getting?”

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Ask someone close to you today: “What’s one thing I could do this week that would really help you?” Then do it.

PRAY

Jesus, You came not to be served but to serve. I confess how often I keep score and think of myself first. Give me a humble heart. Show me how to put others first in practical ways, starting today. Amen.

JOURNAL

Where in my relationships have I been focused on my own things? What would serving look like there?

☐ Read today’s reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Jesus told a story about two builders and one storm. Tomorrow we find out what makes a house, or a relationship, stand.

WEEK THREE Day 20 / 21

Built on the Rock

On a sunny day, every house looks strong. You only find out what it's built on when the storm comes.

> *Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man, which built his house upon a rock: And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell not: for it was founded upon a rock.*
>
> MATTHEW 7:24–25 · KJV

Jesus ended the Sermon on the Mount with a simple story. Two men built houses. One built on rock, the other on sand. From the outside, they may have looked the same. Then the rain, floods and wind came, and only one house stood.

What made the difference? Not whether they heard Jesus' words; both did. The wise man "heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them." The foundation is obedience: actually living out what Jesus said, day after day.

Every relationship will face storms: job loss, illness, conflict, temptation, grief, seasons when feelings fade. Couples who survive aren't the ones with the most romance. They're the ones who built on something deeper than feelings, who kept doing what Jesus said when it was hard.

You can start building now. Every time you choose honesty, forgiveness, patience and prayer, you're pouring concrete into the foundation. And if your house feels shaky today, it's not too late. Jesus is a Rock you can still build on.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 20

Feelings are weather. Jesus is my foundation.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write down one specific teaching of Jesus you've heard but haven't been doing in your relationships. Take one step to obey it this week.

PRAY

Lord Jesus, I don't want to just hear Your words; I want to build my life on them. Be the foundation of my heart and my relationships. When the storms come, hold us steady. Help me obey You in the small things today. Amen.

JOURNAL

What storms has my heart or my relationship faced? What did they reveal about my foundation?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Tomorrow is our last day. We'll read a verse that describes love stronger than floods, and the greatest love story ever told.

WEEK THREE Day 21 / 21

Love Stronger Than the Floods

You've spent 21 days thinking about love. Today we look at the love behind all the others.

> *Set me as a seal upon thine heart, as a seal upon thine arm: for love is strong as death ... Many waters cannot quench love, neither can the floods drown it:*
>
> SONG OF SOLOMON 8:6–7 · KJV

Near the end of the Song of Solomon, the bride asks her beloved: "Set me as a seal upon thine heart." A seal was a personal stamp, often worn on a cord around the neck or on the hand. She is asking to belong to him completely, permanently. And she describes love as "strong as death," a love that "many waters cannot quench."

Human love at its best is a beautiful reflection of this. But even the strongest marriage is a picture pointing to something greater. Scripture calls Jesus the Bridegroom and His people the bride (Ephesians 5:31–32, Revelation 19:7). The greatest love story is His love for you.

His love was literally stronger than death. He went through the floods of the cross so that nothing could ever separate you from Him. And through the Holy Spirit, you are "sealed unto the day of redemption" (Ephesians 4:30). You are set as a seal on His heart.

Whatever happens in your love life, single, dating, married, widowed, waiting, you are not unloved. You are kept by a love that many waters cannot quench. That's where these 21 days end, and where every good love story begins: "We love him, because he first loved us" (1 John 4:19).

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 21

I am loved with a love stronger than death. I am kept.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write a short letter to God about what these 21 days have shown you about love, and about His love for you.

PRAY

Jesus, thank You for loving me first and loving me best. Your love was stronger than death, and nothing can quench it. Whatever my love story holds, I want You at the center. Set me as a seal upon Your heart, and keep me close forever. Amen.

JOURNAL

A letter to God: what these 21 days taught me about love, and how I want to love from here.

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

You made it Turn the page — there's one more thing waiting for you.

TWENTY-ONE DAYS

You are kept.

Whether you're waiting, dating or married, you've spent three weeks bringing your heart to the One who guards it best. Love on earth is a beautiful gift. His love is the one that never fails, and it will keep you all the way home.

✦

Where do I go from here?

Keep the rhythm. Keep your same time and place. Before you text, swipe or speak, pray: *Lord, keep my heart today.*

Read a love story. Read the book of Ruth, one chapter a day for four days. Watch how loyalty, kindness and God's quiet guidance write the story.

Find wise people. Ask one married couple you admire if you can learn from them, or join a small group at a Bible-teaching local church.

Pass it on. Think of one friend who is lonely, dating or struggling in marriage, and send them this book.

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"Freely ye have received, freely give."

MATTHEW 10:8

Not able to give right now? Please don't feel any pressure. You can help just as much by sharing this book with a friend, or by leaving a note in our community about what God did in these 21 days. We read every one.

Gifts go to Elonai Store, an independent creator, to fund free faith resources. Elonai Store is not a registered charity, so gifts are not tax-deductible.

PASS IT ON

Who came to mind?

As you read these pages, someone probably came to mind: a friend who's tired of waiting, a couple who's struggling, a teenager forming ideas about love. You can be the one who points them to a love that lasts.

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Lifting them up

People and needs I'm praying for.

DATE	NAME / NEED	SCRIPTURE I'M PRAYING	✓

ANSWERED PRAYERS

He was faithful

Write it down so you never forget how He answered.

DATE ASKED	REQUEST	HOW GOD ANSWERED	DATE

CUT-OUT SCRIPTURE CARDS

Keep His Word close

Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.

PROVERBS 4:23 · KJV

Delight thyself also in the LORD; and he shall give thee the desires of thine heart.

PSALM 37:4 · KJV

And ye are complete in him.

COLOSSIANS 2:10 · KJV

They that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength.

ISAIAH 40:31 · KJV

Charity suffereth long, and is kind.

1 CORINTHIANS 13:4 · KJV

A threefold cord is not quickly broken.

ECCLESIASTES 4:12 · KJV

Even as Christ forgave you, so also do ye.

COLOSSIANS 3:13 · KJV

Many waters cannot quench love, neither can the floods drown it.

SONG OF SOLOMON 8:7 · KJV

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"We love him, because he first loved us."

1 JOHN 4:19

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